As the press coverage increased, Lieutenant Colonel Edward M. Bush III, who was the public affairs spokesman for Guantánamo, responded to our leak by saying it was no longer like that. The manual related how things had been under Geoffrey Miller. So we then leaked the 2004 manual so that people could compare the two. What they found was that the second manual was, if anything, worse. They revealed how the prison would perform these show-trial rituals, and how, when a visiting dignitary came to call, the prisoners had to turn their heads away. That kind of thing. Oh, and where was Miller posted after Guantánamo? Abu Ghraib.

We wanted people to have an opportunity to understand exactly what was going on under our noses, and that it stank. We were able to describe how the renditions actually happened and we printed the floor plan of the aircraft that carried the detainees to the island. The detainees somehow required goggles, helmets and hoods, and had to be chained to the floor. Why did the US authorities imagine these men had superhero powers? What deep well of fantasy did that tap into?

WikiLeaks was gathering momentum. The Guantánamo leak, and the accompanying press coverage, brought us more sensitive material. The US Army's report into the Battle of Fallujah was marked classified for twenty-five years. But we posted it as soon as it was handed to us in December 2007. On 31 March 2004, four Americans working for the private security firm Blackwater were kidnapped by Iraqi insurgents who beat them, burned them, and hung their bodies off a bridge. The following attack by US troops was reactive, and the report made it clear that there had not been enough planning beforehand, not enough understanding of the political landscape or preparing of the media. Growing civilian casualties led to pressure on the US from the Iraqi Governing Council and a unilateral ceasefire was announced on 9 April. The WikiLeaks documents made it clear the fighting did not cease, however – 'the ceasefire was a bit of a misnomer' – and also revealed that the whole operation had been mounted more as a media-pleasing exercise than anything else.

Our leaked document made it clear that the attack was ordered at the behest of Donald Rumsfeld, who resented the way Fallujah had become a 'symbol of resistance'. There were many civilians in the area and these facts were ignored by the US military. A journalist from Al Jazeera who was known to me, Ahmed Mansour, was in the city during the final assault, and he and his colleague were attempting to tell the truth about the battle